[INCH-POUND]
A-A-59253
June 16, 1998
SUPERSEDING
L-P-65C
September 30, 1977

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PAILS, UTILITY, PLASTIC

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description (CID) covers plastic pails used for carrying liquid and dry material.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The pails covered by this CID are classified by the following sizes and styles as specified (see 7.2):

SIZES

Size 1 - 5 pint (2.4 litre (L)).
Size 2 - 5 quart (4.7 L).
Size 3 - 10 quart (9.5 L).
Size 4 - 12 quart (11.4 L).

STYLES

Style A - Galvanized steel bail.
Style B - Rubber or plastic coated steel bail.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Officer In Charge (Code 15E2), Seabee Logistics Center, 4111 San Pedro St., Port Hueneme, CA 93043-4410, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 7240

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Standard commercial product. The pails shall, as a minimum, be in accordance with the requirements of this CID and shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product. Additional or better features which are not specifically prohibited by this CID but which are a part of the manufacturer's standard commercial product, shall be included in the pails being furnished. A standard commercial product is a product which has been sold or is being sold or is being currently offered for sale on the commercial market through advertisements or manufacturer's catalogs, or brochures, and represents the latest production model.

3.2 Design and construction.

3.2.1 Pail bodies. The pail shall be constructed from polyethylene. The bottom, side, and top rim of the pail shall be an integral unit and shall be impervious to calcium hypochlorite. The color of the body shall be at the manufacturer's option, however, yellow shall not be permitted. The top rim of the pail shall be curled outward and down the side of the pail and may be reinforced with wire. The size 1 pail may be furnished with or without a reinforcing rim. Two diametrically opposite bail ears shall be molded into the rim. The size 4 pail shall be provided with a pouring lip. At the option of the manufacturer, size 3 pails may have a pouring lip. The pail shall be free of fins, sharp edges, mold marks, lumps or included foreign matter.

3.2.1.1 Graduation markings. The size 1 pail shall have 1.0 pint ± 0.8 ounce (oz) (0.473 L ± 24.0 millilitre (mL) graduations. The size 2, 3, and 4 pails shall have 1.0 quart ± 1.6 oz (0.95 L ± 47.3 mL) graduations.

3.2.2. Bails. The bail for the size 4 style B pail shall be a rubber or plastic coated bail. A plastic handle on the bail providing a comfortable grip is acceptable.

3.3 Diametrical deflections. Diametrical deflections are not applicable to the size 1 pail. The bail shall not become detached and the diametrical deflections of the fully loaded pail shall be as follows:

Size 2: Not greater than 1.50 inches (38.0 mm).
Size 3: Not greater than 1.875 inches (47.6 mm).
Size 4: Not greater than 2.0 inches (50.8 mm).

3.4 Markings. Each pail shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name, trade name, or trademark. Markings secured to the pail with adhesives shall be acceptable.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 Materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR). Unless otherwise specified herein, all equipment, material, and articles incorporated in the work covered by this commercial item description are to be new and fabricated using materials

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

produced from recovered materials to the maximum extent possible without jeopardizing the intended use. The term “recovered materials” means materials which have been collected or recovered from solid waste and reprocessed to become a source of raw materials, as opposed to virgin raw materials. Unless otherwise specified, none of the above shall be interpreted to mean that the use of used or rebuilt products are allowed under this commercial item description.

4.2 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, provided they fall within specified tolerances using conversion tables contained in the latest version of ASTM SI-10 (IEEE/ASTM SI-10) and all other requirements of this commercial item description including form, fit and function are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer’s own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

6. PACKAGING. The preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Source of documents.

7.1.1 The Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

7.1.2 ASTM Standard is available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

7.1.3 IEEE Standard is available from the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE), IEEE Service Center, 445 Hoes Lane, P.O. Box 1331, Piscataway, NJ 08855-1331.

7.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

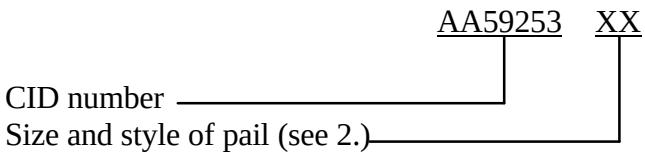
a. Title, number, and date of this CID.
b. Size and style of pails required (see 2.).

7.3 Metric units. The values stated in either inch-pound or SI units are to be regarded separately as standard. Within the text, the SI units are shown in brackets. The values stated in

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

each system are not exact equivalents; therefore, each system should be used independently of the other. Combining values from the two systems may result in non-conformance with the standard.

7.4 Part Identification Numbers (PINs). The following part identification numbering procedure is for government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor. The PIN used for items acquired to this commercial item description are created as follows:



Size 1 = 1
Size 2 = 2
Size 3 = 3
Size 4 = 4

Style A = A
Style B = B

7.5 Classification cross reference. Classifications used in this CID (see 2.) are identical to those found in the superseded Federal Specification L-P-65C.

7.6 Suppression data. This CID replaces Federal Specification L-P-65C, dated September 30, 1977.

7.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Bails
Integral unit

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - GL
Navy - YD1
Air Force - 99

Review Activities:
Air Force - 03, 84

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Preparing Activity:
Navy - YD1

(Project 7240-0277)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.

2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.

3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	**1. DOCUMENT NUMBER** A-A-59253	**2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)** 980616

3. DOCUMENT TITLE PAILS, UTILITY, PLASTIC

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME *(Last, First, Middle Initial)*	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)*	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON *(if applicable)*	**7.DATE SUBMITTED** (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME ROMULO NICHOLAS	b. TELEPHONE *Include Area Code)* (1) Commercial ((805)982-6063 (2) AUTOVON 551-6063
c. ADDRESS *(Include Zip Code)Commander* OFFICER IN CHARGE, SEABEE LOGISTICS CENTER CODE 15E2, 4111 SAN PEDRO STREET PORT HUENEME, CA 93043-4410	**IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT:** DEFENSE QUALITY AND STANDARDIZATION OFFICE 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22401-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.